

Nikos Vasileiadis

Software Engineering Manager · Leeds, UK (GMT/BST — 1 hour behind CET) · British & Greek (EU) Citizen
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Summary

Engineering Manager with 20+ years in technology and 9 years in leadership — 4 of them line-managing engineers — working across regulated industries — financial services, utilities, energy, and public sector technology. I build teams, maintain platforms, and focus on creating the right conditions for people to do good work. Currently managing platform and content services at Utility Warehouse (FTSE 250), a UK multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile and insurance.

Based in Leeds, UK. Greek (EU) citizen — full right to work in the Netherlands and across the EU. Open to remote roles with Dutch and European organisations. The timezone overlap with CET is seamless.

What I Bring

- **People & teams** — Building and retaining remote engineering teams. 100% retention across three company restructurings. 3 promotions supported through evidence-based cases informed by DORA metrics. Using DORA, team health tracking, and Heartbeat surveys to keep performance visible and sustainable.
- **Organisational design** — Navigating restructurings, building teams from scratch, aligning team structures with what the business actually needs. Have built the same team twice from zero.
- **Platform & infrastructure** — Running critical platform services with clear SLAs and operational discipline for 15+ dependent engineering teams.
- **Design systems** — From co-creating an open-source design system (Pulsar) to leading enterprise-wide adoption across 20 teams.
- **Commercial awareness** — a £200k+ annual vendor portfolio across six platform services, CapEx/OpEx planning, vendor evaluation, R&D tax credit documentation. Engineering decisions are business decisions.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

Jul 2023 – Present · United Kingdom · Remote

- **Team & retention:** Grew to 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs — web/CMS/tracking, mobile, and design systems. Six direct reports, plus a Design Systems Lead and a Staff Engineer whose day-to-day management and 1:1s I held on a dotted line, alongside a Product Manager. Everyone who wanted to stay, stayed — 100% retention through three reorganisations that moved the team across three departments in 25 months: Platforms (May 2023), Customer Experience (Jul 2024), Partner (Jun 2025), the last reducing it to a specialist core. All reductions were organisational; zero voluntary attrition.
- **Measurement-led leadership:** Progressed from manual team health tracking (TeamRetro) and custom dashboards to the DX platform. Uses DORA metrics (deployment frequency, lead time, change failure rate, MTTR) to inform promotion cases and bonus decisions. Complements with monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys — acting on engagement and wellbeing signals, not just collecting them.

- **Growing people:** Supported 3 promotions (Associate → Mid, Mid → Senior) with evidence-based cases. Several engineers I mentored have since moved into Engineering Manager roles, both inside and outside the company.
- **Navigating restructurings:** When the organisation restructured, I took responsibility for scoping team migrations — mapping scope, aligning stakeholders, and building consensus for where the team should sit. Nobody asked me to do this; it needed doing. When the Customer Experience move added a mobile backlog, I negotiated the transfer in of a Senior Engineer with mobile expertise, so the team's capability matched its new remit.
- **Preserving what mattered:** Advocated for keeping the Design Systems team when a restructuring would have dissolved it. That team later enabled the company-wide rebrand.
- **Documentation culture:** Wrote over 100 articles of technical documentation — process guides, architecture decisions, onboarding materials. The team inherited an undocumented legacy CMS; we mapped everything systematically and built a documentation practice from scratch.
- **Technical upskilling:** When the team needed Kubernetes knowledge, I learned it first, then trained the team and documented it. Encouraged engineers to own RFCs, present at cross-team forums, and share knowledge — so they could operate independently across the full stack.
- **Hiring:** Involved in hiring 2 external engineers and facilitating 4 internal transfers — candidate assessment, interviews, and onboarding.
- **Rebranding programme (Oct 2025 – Apr 2026):** The team delivered UW's brand refresh across 522 pages of the uw.co.uk estate — the primary digital entry point for customers and partners. Our work was the critical path: other teams' rebranding couldn't go live until we shipped. We wrote automated migration scripts that saved content editors hundreds of manual hours.
- **Platform reliability:** uw.co.uk operated against a 99.99% SLO — a single incident in the current year, resolved within hours, zero downtime otherwise — with <3s page load on critical pages. The estate: 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, 1,090 shortlinks, 218 redirects. Supporting 8 content teams (33 users) and 15+ engineering teams as platform dependencies. Responsible for six platform services: Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, OneTrust — monitored via Kubernetes, Sentry, Prometheus, Pingdom, and Cloudflare.
- **Design Systems (Hearth):** The Hearth Design System reached 20 engineering and product teams (15 full adoption, 5 partial). Consolidating components at the design system level removed thousands of hours of duplicated work across the organisation. Contributed to R&D tax credit claims by translating the technical work into audit-ready documentation.
- **CMS migration (Apostrophe → Contentful):** Replaced a legacy CMS that had no SLA, no SSO, and a dead tech stack. Ran a 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors, shortlisted to 3, selected Contentful — a six-figure annual enterprise contract, chosen for enterprise-grade SLAs and support. Executed a zero-disruption migration; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained structured content models, scheduling, and eliminated duplication.
- **Working with constraints (2025–present):** After restructurings reduced the team to 2 engineers, I absorbed Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside my management role. The team continued to deliver across 6 platform services without breaching the platform SLO, with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

Lead Software Engineer

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

May 2022 – Jul 2023 · United Kingdom · Remote

Joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing — no department, no precedent, no documentation.

- Started as three — myself, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer — and held that shape for a full year. Line-managed the engineer from May 2022: for my first year I reported directly to a VP of Engineering — no Head of Engineering in between — so people responsibility was mine from the start, 14 months before the title followed. Grew to five in May 2023 with two external hires; promoted the founding Associate to Software Engineer a month later — a promotion case I was asked to prepare and drive while still Lead. Renamed Content Capability (Nov 2022) and moved into the Platforms department (May 2023) — the first of three reorganisations the team would outlast.
- Set up a Scrum environment with structured backlog and predictable delivery, filling Product Manager gaps when needed. Conducted systematic discovery on the legacy CMS, authored the team's foundational documentation.
- Led the vendor evaluation that resulted in UW adopting Contentful as its enterprise CMS. Presented findings and full audit trail to leadership.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

IMA-HOME

Jan 2020 – Apr 2022 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Combined frontend architecture with Scrum Master responsibilities for global clients (Adidas, MARS).

- Introduced structured Agile/Scrum practices to an agency that had been running on ad-hoc delivery. Result: measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos.
- Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's global web presence — a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support.

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)

Oct 2018 – Jan 2020 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society — a regulated financial services environment — while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- Introduced Agile and Scrum to LBS for the first time — shifting from ad-hoc output to sprint-based delivery with measurable velocity.
- Appointed as Interim Scrum Master (Jun–Oct 2019) to stabilise delivery during the Digital Transformation programme, working alongside external consultants and cross-functional teams.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Jadu

Jan 2017 – Oct 2018 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by UK Local Authorities, universities, and third-sector organisations. Strict focus on accessibility and W3C standards.

- Co-created **Pulsar** — an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is where my design systems specialism started.
- Owned the full feature lifecycle for the CMS product — contextual inquiry at client sites (councils, universities), field research reports, mockups, usability testing, and production release.
- Gained hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

Early Career, Teaching & Community

Oct 2005 – Dec 2016 (11 years)

Provincial northern Greece — Xanthi, where I grew up; Serres, where I studied: no tech industry and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway, and led long before I had a title for it.

- **Web development & freelancing (2005–2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally — from local non-profits to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed client relationships, billing (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed teams.
- **Teaching & mentorship (2006–2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional qualification. Taught ECDL to adult learners for a year. Privately tutored a student in programming and hardware — that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and now works at Sophos.
- **Community & civic technology (2008–2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a 350-person national open-source conference), and managed digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, and community organisations. This work directly shaped my later community involvement in the UK.
- **UK agency work (2015–2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Built responsive e-commerce for global brands (Vivienne Westwood) and focused on frontend performance.

Community & Volunteering

Mentor, WRK digital (*Feb 2023–Present*): Mentoring engineers who have gone on to become Engineering Managers. Part of a peer network spanning EMs, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code (*Aug 2023–Jan 2024*): Supported people entering the industry through their first engineering roles.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds (*Jan 2019–Mar 2020*): Revived an inactive chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and meetups.

Education

International University of Greece — Serres Campus

BSc Informatics Engineering (2007–2012) — strong grades in software engineering, programming, and databases. Left without the certificate when the Greek economic crisis hit; the freelance business I was already running became the career.

Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026

Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023

Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022–2023

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list available on the [Credentials](#) page.